

Gender equality

Gender equality occurs when men and women have the same opportunities and rights. Equal opportunities and rights mean that every individual, regardless of their gender, is free to realize their full potential.

The idea that there are certain toys, roles, and activities that belong just to boys or just to girls places limitations upon everyone and can keep young people from achieving their goals and ambitions. Unfortunately, because these assumptions are so widespread, they're often accepted and even encouraged by people without them questioning it. But this is changing—more and more people now acknowledge that a person's gender should not dictate their interests or dreams.



◁ **In the home**
Equality of roles in the home encourages everyone to learn essential life skills.

PARENT TIPS

Gender equality at home

- Teens of either gender should have the freedom to express themselves and their emotions honestly.
- Make sure that rules are based on maturity, rather than gender.
- Both genders should participate equally in the household, part of which involves sharing chores.



△ **Gender equality in play**
Gender equality can be encouraged from a young age by letting boys and girls play any type of role, with any type of toy, free from gender stereotypes.

Tackling inequality

Inequality can seem like too big of an issue for one person to tackle on their own, but there are things a person can do to make the world a fairer place.

Take responsibility for day-to-day words and actions.

Understand that there is no "one-size-fits-all" solution to a problem.

Talk to lots of people from all types of backgrounds to make sure their needs are being met.

Stand up for people's rights to live without encountering barriers, whenever it's safe to do so.

Report bullying and abusive comments or behavior to a parent, teacher, or the police.

Write to politicians to tell them about changes they should make.

GOOD TO KNOW

Explaining privilege

Privilege refers to any unasked for or unearned advantages given to one group of people over another. These advantages might be based on ability, age, education, family income, race, or sex. You can be privileged in some ways but not others, such as being born into a stable, comfortable family, but with a physical disability. It can feel awkward to talk about your own privilege, but that discomfort can help you to be more aware of inequality and to do something about it.